

What is coding?

Computer programmers, or “coders”, are people who write step-by-step instructions that can make a computer perform a task. Coders can get computers to do sums, make music, move a robot across a room, or fly a rocket to Mars.

Dumb boxes

A computer can't do anything of its own accord – it just sits there like a dumb box until it's told exactly what to do. Because computers can't think for themselves and can only do as they're told, coders have to do the thinking for them and write their instructions carefully.



△ Performing pet

By learning how to code, you'll be able to write your own programs and make the computer do what you want. It's a bit like having an electronic pet that you can teach to perform tricks!

Programming languages

In order to tell a computer what to do, you need to learn a programming language. Visual languages are easy for beginners to learn, while professional coders use text-based languages. This book is based on the popular text-based language Python.



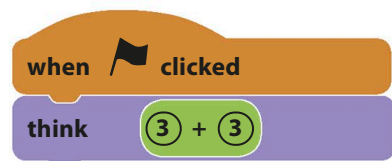
Why don't you say something?

▽ Scratch

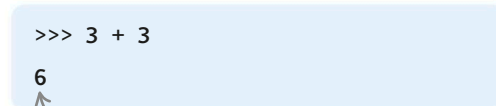
Scratch is a visual programming language. It's great for creating games, animations, and interactive stories. You write code in Scratch by snapping together blocks of instructions.

▽ Python

Python is a text-based programming language. In Python, programmers write code using words, abbreviations, numbers, and symbols. Instructions are typed in using the computer's keyboard.



Both these bits of code do the same thing.



The answer to the sum is shown on the screen in a “thinks” bubble.

You hit the enter/return key to see the result.

